

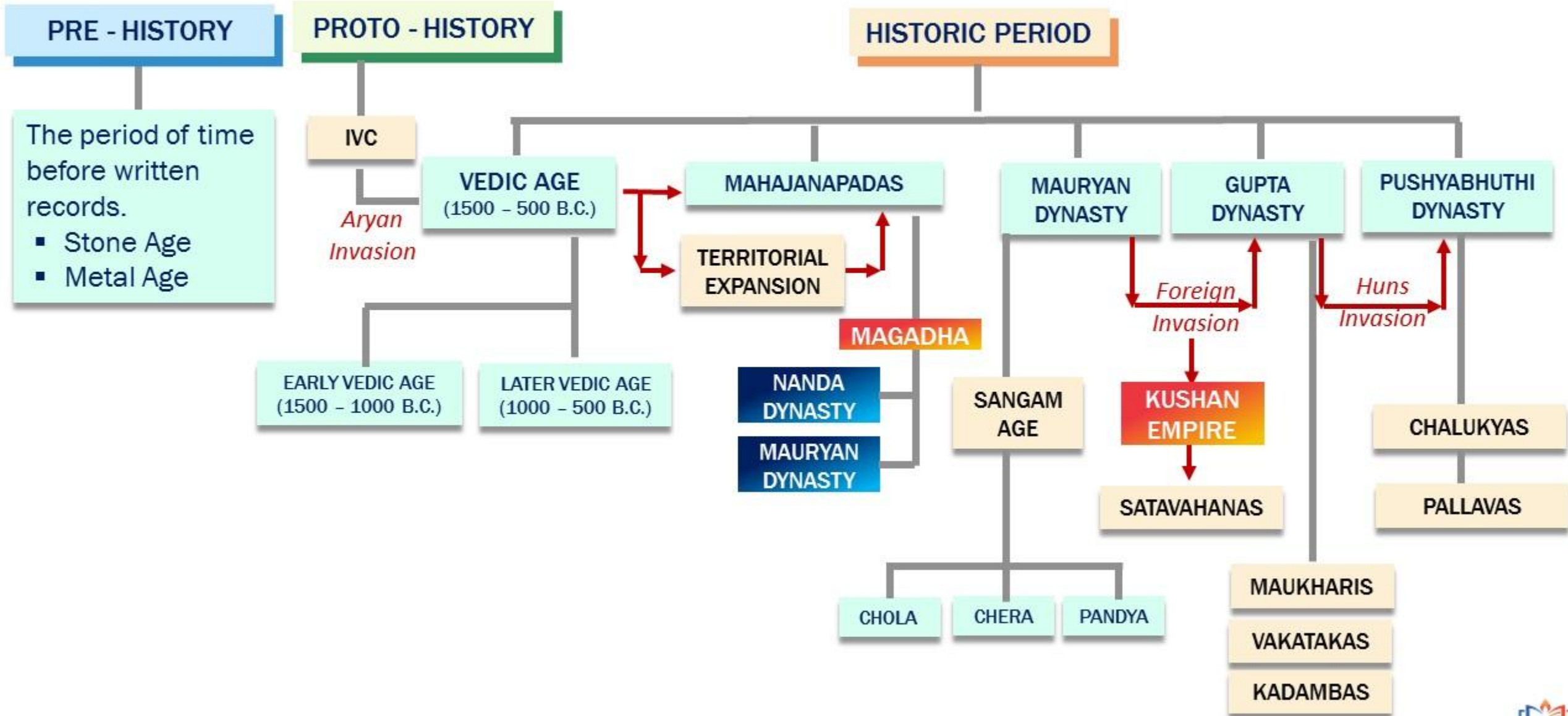
ANCIENT HISTORY



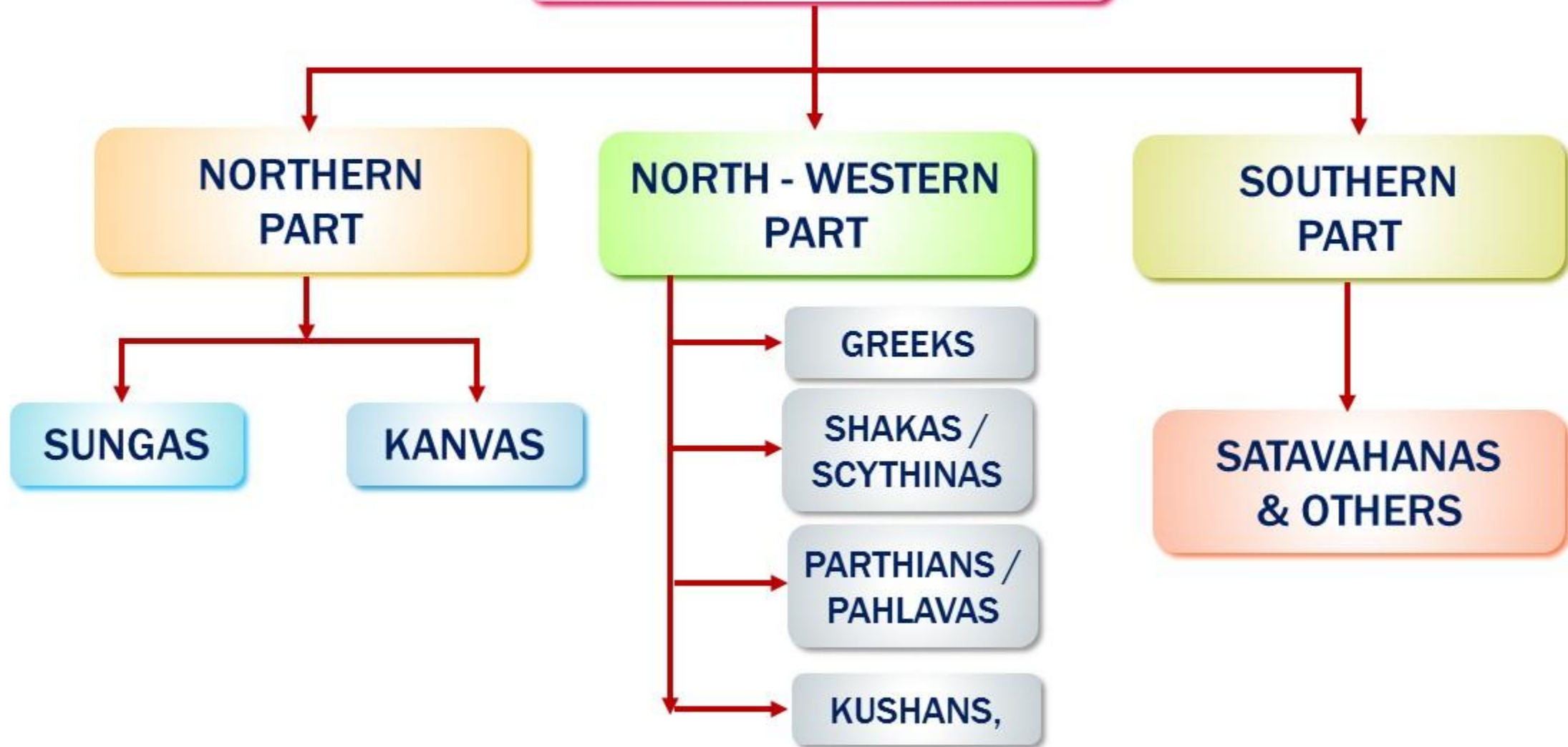
MODULE - 15

POST MAURYAN
NORTHERN EMPIRES

POST MAURYAN ERA



POST MAURYAN PHASE



POST MAURYAN ERA

COMPARISON

NEW PHASE



1. DISINTEGRATION
2. DECENTRALISATION
3. BRAHMINICAL REVIVALISM
4. LINGUISTIC REVIVALISM - SANSKRIT
5. FOREIGN INVASION



POST-MAURYAN EMPIRES



**KUSHAN
EMPIRE**

CHINA

**SUNGA
EMPIRE**

**WESTERN
SATRAPS**

INDIA

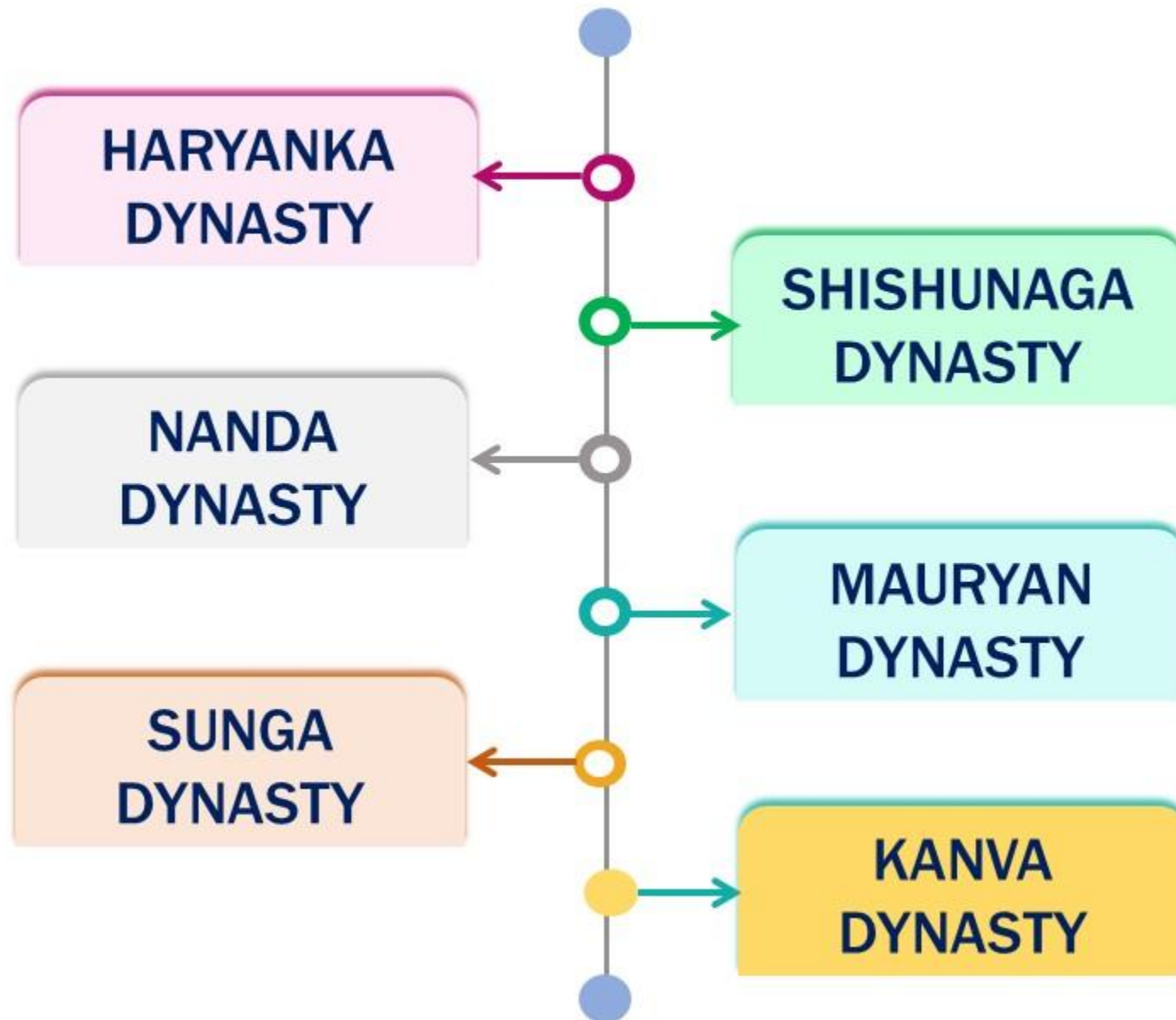
KALINGA

**SATAVAHANA
EMPIRE**

Arabian Sea

Bay of Bengal

MAGADHAN DYNASTIES



ABOUT THE DYNASTY

SOURCES

KINGS AND THEIR CONTRIBUTION

CONSOLIDATION OF EMPIRE AND TERRITORIAL EXTENT

POLITICAL STRUCTURE/ SOCIAL LIFE/ ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

SIGNIFICANCE OF THE DYNASTY

HOW DYNASTY DECLINED

OTHER FACTS

SUNGA DYNASTY

(185 BC - 75 BC)

ABOUT THE DYNASTY



BRIHADRATHA
THE LAST MAURYAN RULER

Assassinated
by

PUSHYAMITRA SUNGA
THE COMMANDER OF MAURYAN
DYNASTY

ABOUT THE DYNASTY

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SIGNIFICANCE OF THE DYNASTY

HOW DYNASTY DECLINED

OTHER FACTS

THE SOURCES OF SUNGA DYNASTY

ARCHAEOLOGICAL

LITERARY

RELIGIOUS

- Buddhist scripture
- Brahminical sources

SECULAR

PLAYS / DRAMAS / POEMS

- Mahabhasya of Patanjali
- Harshacharita of Banabhatta
- Malavikaagnimitra of Kalidasa
- Asthadhyayi of Panini

COINS

(Numismatics)



MONUMENTS

STUPAS, VIHARAS



ARTIFACTS

& OBJECTS



INSCRIPTIONS

AND EDICTS



OTHERS



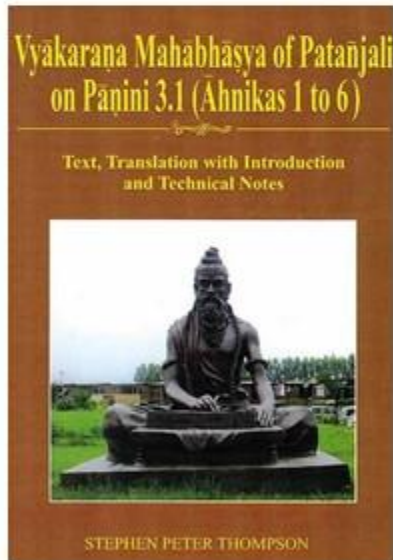
POST MAURYAN ERA

SUNGA DYNASTY

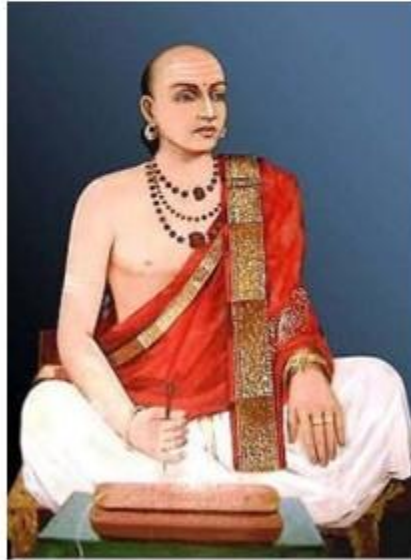
(185 BC - 75 BC)

SOURCES

**Mahabhasya
of Patanjali**



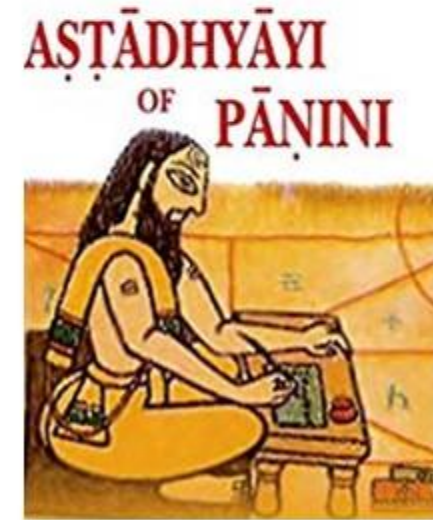
**Harshacharita
of Banabhatta**



**Malavikaagnimitra
of kalidasa**



**Asthadhyayi
of Panini**



ABOUT THE DYNASTY

SOURCES

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SUNGA DYNASTY

(185 BC - 75 BC)

GENEALOGY OF KINGS



185 BC

PUSHYAMITRA
SUNGA

AGNIMITRA

VASUMITRA

BHAGABHADRA

DEVABHUTI

75 BC

POST MAURYAN ERA

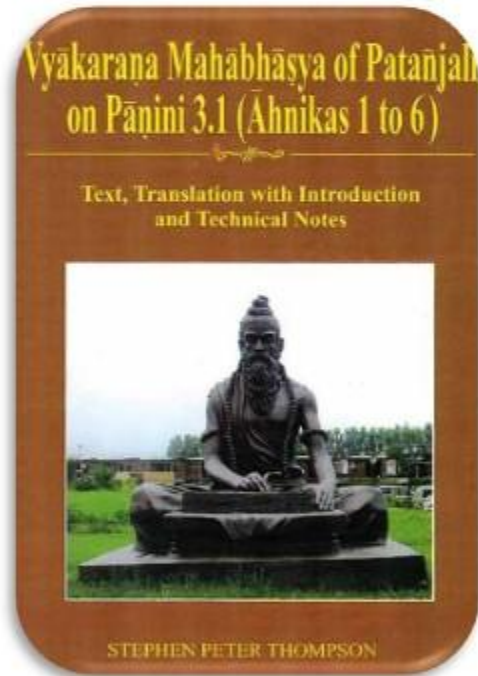
SUNGA DYNASTY

(185 BC - 75 BC)

1

PUSHYAMITRA SUNGA

(185 BC - 149 BC)



Grammarians Patañjali was the contemporary of Pushyamitra



1

He is founder of Sunga Dynasty.

2

- On western front, he checked the advancements of **Bactrian greeks/yavanas**.
- On eastern front, he fought against Kharavela of Kalinga (which became independent after decline of Mauryan empire).

3

He was **staunch follower of Brahmanism** and he is credited to revival of Brahmanism and Ashwmedha (horse) sacrifice.

POST MAURYAN ERA

CHEDI DYNASTY

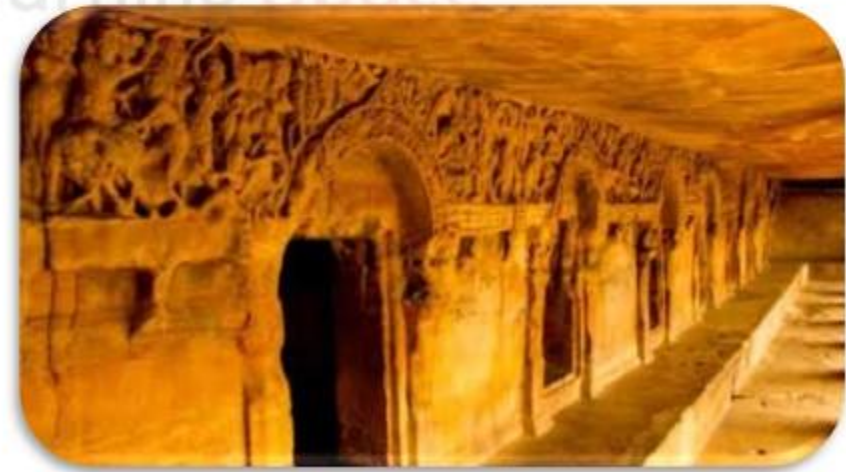
(185 BC - 75 BC)

KHARAVELA

- 1 Kalinga region was ruled by Chedi Dynasty (Mahameghavahana dynasty.)



- 2 ✓ Kharavela was the most powerful king and followed Jainism.
✓ Only source of information about the king is the Hathigumpha inscription written in Prakrit language and Brahmi script.



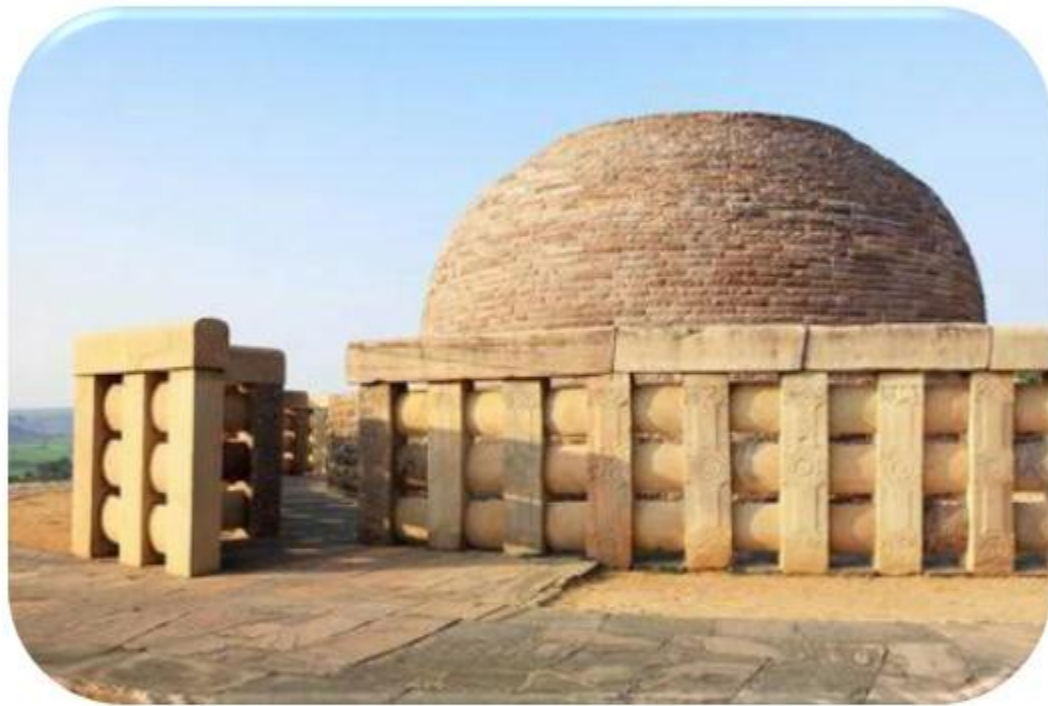
HATHIGUMPHA INSCRIPTION

POST MAURYAN ERA

SUNGA DYNASTY

(185 BC - 75 BC)

PUSHYAMITRA SUNGA AND BUDDHISM



RAILINGS WERE ADDED

1

- Buddhist sources refer him as a persecutor of Buddhist.
- But there is enough evidence to show that Pushyamitra patronised Buddhist art.

2

- During his reign the Buddhist monuments at Bharhut and Sanchi were renovated and further improved.
 - ✓ Railings were added around Sanchi Stupa.
 - ✓ Gates and walls were built around Bharut Stupa.

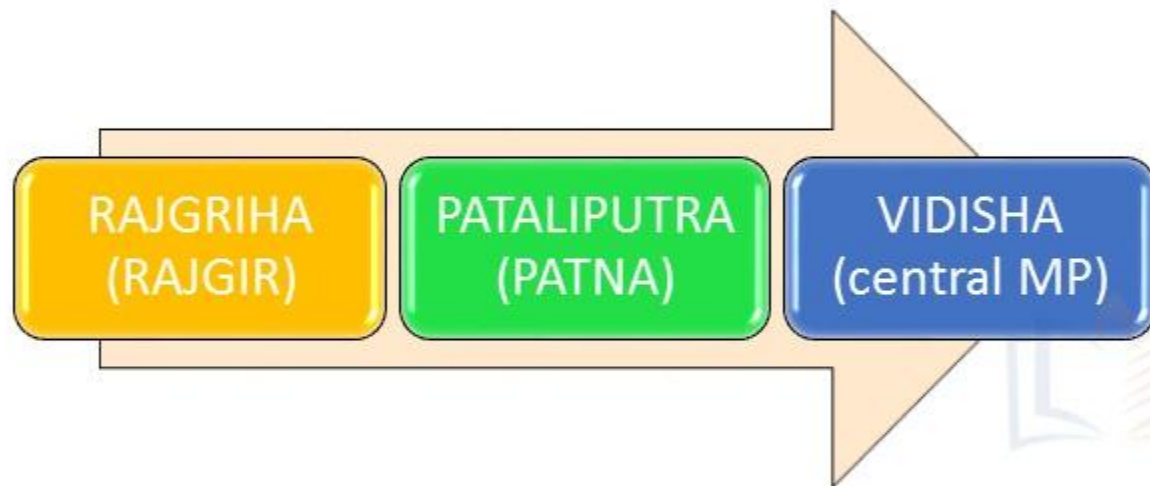
POST MAURYAN ERA

SUNGA DYNASTY

(185 BC - 75 BC)

2 AGNIMITRA

(149 BC - 141 BC)



Rajgriha was the capital of magadha during the pre-mauryan phase, pataliputra was the capital in mauryan phase, later vidisha was made capital in the post mauryan phase.

- 1** After death of Pushyamitra, his son Agnimitra (hero of *Malvikagnimitram* of Kalidasa) became the ruler.
- 2** Pushyamitra and his son Agnimitra ruled from Pataliputra.
- 3** The later Sungas made Vidisha as their capital.



GRECO-BACTRIAN KINGDOM

Sagala (Sialkot)

CHINA

PAKISTAN

Campaign of Sunga

★Pataliputra

Bharhut

Ujjain

Vidisha

SUNGA EMPIRE

BANGLADESH

MYANMAR (BURMA)

Arabian Sea

SATAVAHANA EMPIRE

Bay of Bengal

POST MAURYAN ERA

SUNGA DYNASTY

(185 BC - 75 BC)

3 LATER SUNGAS



HELIODORUS

- He is known for erecting stone column at besnagar i.e. Garuda pillar or heliodorus pillar dedicated to **God Vasudeva** at MP.
- It is one of the earliest known inscription related to **Vaishnavism**.

3 Vasumitra

- He confronted yavanas.

4 Bhagabhadra

- **Heliodorus**, the Greek ambassador, visited during his reign.

5 Devbhuti

- The last Sunga ruler was Devabhuti, who **was murdered by his amatya** (minister) **Vasudeva Kanva** around 73BC, the founder of the Kanva dynasty.

POST MAURYAN ERA

SUNGA DYNASTY

(185 BC - 75 BC)

SIGNIFICANCE OF SINGAS

4

Revivalism of Sanskrit Period saw the development of **sanskrit language** gradually reached its peak during Guptas.

- Patanjali the greatest literary genius of the period, his Mahabhashya, a commentary on Panini's grammar is celebrated piece of Sanskrit literary work.

3

Checked foreign invasion. Greatest achievement was **Safeguarding of India** from the invasions of Greeks.

1

Religious significance

Revived **Brahminical Hinduism** as is exemplified by horse sacrifices (at the time of Pushyamitra Sunga)

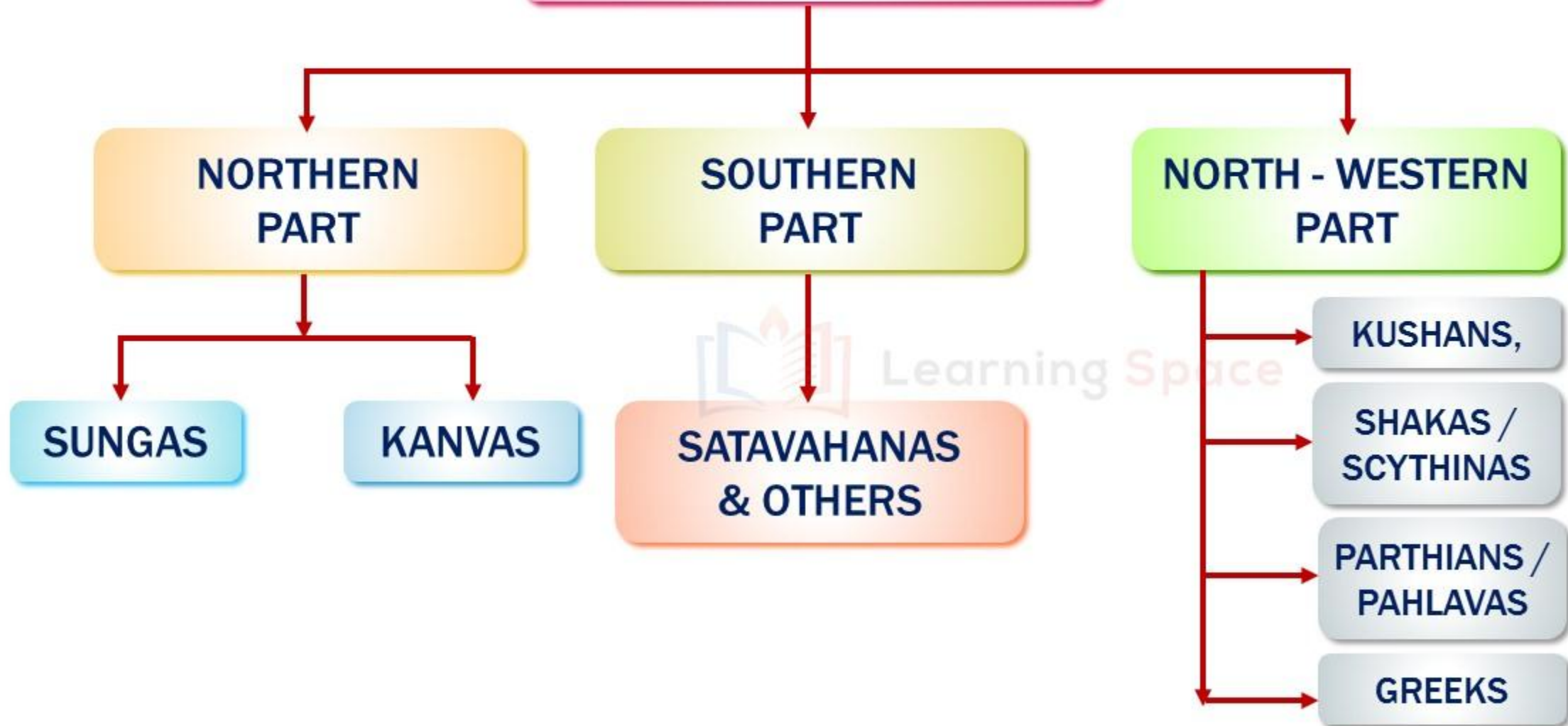
2

Cultural significance

This period saw the **flowering of visual arts**, including small terracotta images, large **stone sculptures and architectural monuments** such as the **chaitya hall at bhaja**, **stupa at bhaurut** and renowned **stupa at sanchi**.

SIGNIFICANCE
OF SINGAS

POST MAURYAN PHASE



POST MAURYAN ERA

KANVA DYNASTY

(75 BC - 30 BC)



- Like their predecessor Sungas, they were **Brahmins in origin**.
- Kanva dynasty ruled for 45 years.
- Kanvas **could not check the advancement of Greek** in NW India, hence lost territories in west. Whereas in eastern side they lost their territories to different rulers.
- This dynasty was finally **overthrown by Satavahanas in 30BC**.

After fall of Kanvas, very little known about Magadha until the rise of Gupta dynasty.

SIGNIFICANCE OF POST-
MAURYAN EMPIRESIGNIFICANCE
OF SUNGAS

1 The period between 200 BCE-300 CE did not witness the emergence of a large empire like that of the Mauryas, but it is a period **notable for many other historical, political, and cultural achievements.**

2 It saw a **series of invasions** and the rise of many regional kingdoms

4 This is also a period where cities expanded, and **urban culture gained a certain predominance.**

3 The period also saw the emergence of sophisticated **sculptural and architectural styles.**

Q & A

Q.1 Consider the following statements:

- i. The last Mauryan ruler Brihadratha was assassinated by his commander-in- chief Pushyamitra Sunga.
- ii. The last Sunga king Devabhuti was assassinated by his Brahmana minister Vasudeva Kanva who usurped the throne.
- iii. The last ruler of the Kanva dynasty was deposed by the Andhras.

Which of these statements is/are correct?

- a) i and ii
- b) Only ii
- c) Only iii
- d) i, ii and iii

ANSWER d)

Q & A

Q.1 Which one of the following books of ancient India has the love story of the son of the founder of Sunga dynasty?

- a) Swapnavasavadatta
- b) Malavikaagnimitra
- c) Meghdoota
- d) Ratnavali

ANSWER b)

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